

Poem: The River by Valerie Bloom

2. Read the lines and answer the questions

a. *“The River’s a wanderer, A nomad, a tramp. She doesn’t choose one place, To set up her camp. The River’s a winder, Through valley and hill. She twists and she turns, She just cannot be still.”*

i. Wanderer, nomad, tramp: what do these three words tell us about the river?

The words ‘Wanderer, nomad, tramp’ tell us that the river does not stay at one place. It has no home or job. It is always moving.

ii. What are the different places that the river flows past in the poem?

The river flows through valleys, hills, and the countryside.

iii. In your own words, give the meaning of ‘to set up camp’.

To set up camp means to stay or live in one place.

b. *“The River’s a hoarder, And she buries down deep All those little treasures, She wants to keep.”*

i. What is the meaning of hoarder? Why is the river called a ‘hoarder’?

The meaning of hoarder is a person who collects and stores things. The river is called a hoarder because it collects and keeps things inside it.

ii. Which word means ‘puts deep inside’?

The word which means “buries” means ‘puts deep inside’.

iii. What do you think are the treasures that the river wants to keep?

The treasures may be stones, sand, pebbles, shells, or soil.

3. Circle the groups of words that describe what the river does NOT do.

stay still

stay in one place

give away her treasures

4. Why does the poet call the river a ‘singer’?

The poet calls the river a singer because the sounds of flowing water are like music or a song.

5. Think of a river you have seen. Is there anything else you can compare a river to?

A river can be compared to a long road, a moving snake, or a dancing ribbon of water.

6. What is the rhyme scheme of the poem?

The rhyme scheme of the poem is ‘abcb’.

MCQs

1. The poet describes the river as a —

- a) mountain
- b) traveller**
- c) house
- d) teacher

2. Which word shows that the river never stays in one place?

- a) still
- b) camp
- c) wanderer**
- d) deep

3. Why is the river called a ‘hoarder’?

- a) It gives away its treasures
- b) It keeps things hidden inside**
- c) It flows very fast
- d) It makes loud sounds

4. The river is compared to a baby because it —

- a) cries loudly
- b) sleeps all day
- c) gurgles and hums**
- d) cannot move

5. The river is called a ‘singer’ because —

- a) it sings songs like people
- b) it dances on stage
- c) it makes musical sounds while flowing**
- d) it talks to the countryside

Chapter 11 Making A Difference

Deep Dive

1 “*Something very wrong has happened and there is nothing we can do about it.*”

RECALL

a. What had happened that was ‘very wrong’?

Madhu and Mehul learnt in their science club meeting that people are polluting the environment and destroying the planet. That was ‘very wrong’.

b. How did the ‘wrong’ thing that happened affect Madhu and Mehul?

The ‘wrong’ thing that happened made Madhu and Mehul feel sad, worried, and helpless. They walked home quietly, did not talk, and were not interested in things they usually enjoyed, like petting a dog or eating their favourite snacks.

INFER

c. What do we understand about Madhu and Mehul’s characters from their reactions to what had happened?

We understand that Madhu and Mehul are caring, responsible, and sensitive children. They are concerned about the environment and feel troubled when they realise the harm being done to it.

ANALYSE

d. How would you react if you faced a situation you could not change?

I would feel upset at first, but then I would try to do small things within my control. Even if I cannot change everything, I would try to make a small positive difference.

2. “The boy did make a difference, didn’t he?” asked Madhu excitedly.

RECALL

a. Who was the boy who made a difference?

The boy who made a difference was the one on the beach who was throwing the stranded starfish back into the ocean.

b. What is the difference that Madhu was talking about?

Madhu was talking about how the boy saved the lives of the starfish by throwing them back into the sea, even though there were many more left on the beach.

INFER

c. How do you think the story of the boy affected Madhu and Mehul? Give reasons.

The story made Madhu and Mehul feel hopeful and encouraged. They understood that even small actions can make a difference, which changed their sadness into confidence and happiness.

ANALYSE

d. Can stories be used to inspire people or change their feelings about something? Explain your answer.

Yes, stories can inspire people and change their feelings. Stories help us understand ideas better and give us examples that motivate us to think positively and act responsibly.

READ, REFLECT AND WRITE

1. What did the children’s mother want to teach them through the story that she narrated?

The mother wanted to teach them that even though we cannot solve all problems, every small effort matters. Doing little good deeds can still make a big difference.

2. What would you do to make a difference to the environment?

I would save water and electricity, avoid using plastic, plant trees, recycle waste, and keep my surroundings clean to help protect the environment.

MCQs

1. Why were Madhu and Mehul quiet while walking home?

- a) They were tired after playing
- b) They had quarrelled with each other
- c) They were upset about the damage to the environment**
- d) They were angry with their parents

2. What did Madhu and Mehul learn about in their science club meeting?

- a) How to make new inventions
- b) How animals live in forests
- c) How people are polluting the environment**
- d) How to recycle paper

3. Why did the children feel that nothing they did would make a difference?

- a) They were too busy with homework
- b) The damage to the environment seemed too great**
- c) Their teacher discouraged them
- d) They did not like the science club

4. In the story told by the mother, what was the boy doing on the beach?

- a) Collecting shells
- b) Watching the waves
- c) Throwing starfish back into the ocean**
- d) Playing with sand

5. What message does the story of the starfish teach us?

- a) Beaches are dangerous places
- b) Children should not help others
- c) Big problems cannot be solved
- d) Small actions can make a big difference**